

Color & Typography

Part of **UI/UX Design Principles** · Estimated time: 35 min

Introduction

Color and type are the two elements a person notices before reading a single word — and both work best when constrained to a small, deliberate set of choices rather than picked ad hoc, screen by screen.

Core ideas

- A simple palette often follows a 60-30-10 split: a dominant neutral (60%), a secondary color (30%), and an accent used sparingly for emphasis (10%).
- A type scale — a small set of font sizes, like 14/16/20/28/40px — keeps headings and body text consistent across every screen instead of being picked freely each time.
- Contrast isn't just aesthetic: WCAG accessibility guidelines require a minimum contrast ratio (commonly 4.5:1 for body text) so text stays legible for people with low vision.
- Limiting yourself to one or two typefaces (often one for headings, one for body) reads as more intentional than mixing several.

Try it yourself

Pick a dominant color, a secondary color, and one accent color for a hypothetical app. Check the contrast between your text color and background using a free contrast checker, and adjust until it passes.

Further reading

- [WebAIM — Contrast Checker](https://webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker/)

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- [Nielsen Norman Group — Typography Terms Every Designer Should Know](https://www.nngroup.com/articles/typography-terms/)

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ModuloTrainer reading material — return to the app to mark this module complete.